objectives and a final treaty was concluded and opened for signature in 1968. This recognized and effectively legalized only five nuclear weapon states: the United States, the Soviet Union, China, France, and the United Kingdom. In October 1967, India made it clear that it would not sign the NPT. As George Perkovich later noted, ‘India may have had logic, principle, and the 1965 negotiating mandate on its side, but the United States and the other nuclear weapon states had power on their side.’ [60]

The Third Way: The Post-Colonial World, 1947–1962

Beyond its territorial integrity and its economic and technological development, another set of foreign policy questions that occupied India’s foreign policy during the early Cold War related to its relations with the rest of the decolonizing world. This included some significant engagements with Africa. In 1960, when Congo became independent, the mineral-rich province of Katanga broke away with financial and military support from the departing colonial power Belgium. Rajeshwar Dayal, India’s high commissioner to Pakistan and later foreign secretary, became the United Nations special envoy as India was seen as a neutral arbiter between competing Western and Soviet interests during the crisis. Between 1961 and 1963, India sent more troops to Congo under a United Nations flag than any other country and helped to put down secessionist forces despite resistance from the country’s new pro-Western leader Mobutu Sese Seko. This intervention resulted in the deaths of thirty-nine Indian soldiers and saw the first award of a Param Vir Chakra—independent India’s highest military honour—in an overseas conflict. [61] Beyond Congo, India played a role in supporting the development and security of other African states. For example, the newly independent country of Ghana—which was sceptical of erstwhile colonists in Britain and both superpowers—sought Indian support in establishing its intelligence agency. [62]

India’s larger leadership role in Asia, against the backdrop of decolonization, is often overlooked today. It began before Independence. In early 1947, Nehru hosted a major Asian Relations Conference in Delhi,